

HONEST CLAIMS

What massage can promise someone with type 1 — and what it can't.

Supported

Feeling calmer: single sessions lowered anxiety, blood pressure and heart rate (37 trials)

Low-quality support

Joint mobilisation + exercise for frozen shoulder in diabetes (8 trials)

Disputed

“Lowers cortisol.” A stricter meta-analysis found the effect indistinguishable from zero

Not shown

Treating diabetes. Glucose drops after massage are likely just faster insulin absorption

Not shown

Preventing complications by “improving circulation.” No guideline lists it

The honest pitch

Go because it feels good and helps you move — not to treat diabetes